

▽ Basil II, the "Bulgar-slayer"



996 CE

BASIL II CAMPAIGNS AGAINST THE BULGARS

Basil II was a highly effective Byzantine emperor, who cemented imperial authority both at home and abroad. Most notably, he neutralized the ambitious Bulgarian kingdom, capturing key Bulgar strongholds such as Skopje. In 1014, he inflicted a devastating defeat on the Bulgar Tsar Samuel at Kleidion, killing 15,000 Bulgars and reputedly blinding 99 out of 100 survivors. The First Bulgarian empire collapsed and the Bulgars posed little threat to Byzantium for 150 years.

1001 Stephen becomes
first king of Hungary,
establishing it as a powerful
European state

1009



△ Pueblo Bonito

c. 1000

CHACO CANYON PUEBLO CIVILIZATION FLOURISHES

The ancient Puebloans of the American southwest reached their zenith with the construction of "great houses" such as Pueblo Bonito, road networks, and irrigation systems that allowed crops to grow in the harsh climate. Within a century, the Chacoan culture had declined, probably as a result of ecological change.

1001 MAHMUD OF GHAZNI INVADES INDIA

Mahmud's actions were the first major Muslim incursions into the Indian subcontinent. In 17 campaigns his armies ranged as far south as Kannauj and Gwalior and sacked the temple of Shiva at Somnath in Gujarat. Although many Indian rulers were reduced to vassalage, his Ghaznavid state only occupied parts of the northwest.

▷ Mahmud of Ghazni

